



NOTE VERBALE

Ref: 15277/10/Vol. 79

The Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International Cooperation of the Republic of Sierra Leone presents its compliments to the Embassy of the United States of America in Freetown, Sierra Leone and has the honour to express its willingness to consider accepting the transfer from the United States of America a maximum of three hundred (300) per annum of citizens of the Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS) present in the United States.

The Government of Sierra Leone would retain complete discretion to accept or reject the transfer of any given individual proposed by the Government of the United States of America.

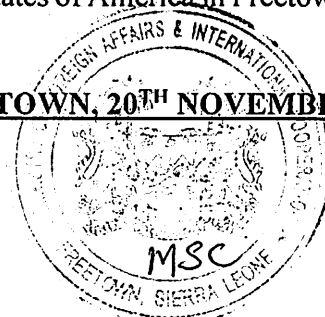
The Government of Sierra Leone assures the Government of the United States of America that it intends to treat any ECOWAS citizens transferred from the United States to Sierra Leone in a manner that is consistent with its obligations under the Convention Relating to the Status of Refugees, done at Geneva on July 28, 1951; the Protocol Relating to the Status of Refugees, done at New York on January 31, 1967; the Convention against Torture and Other Cruel, Inhuman or Degrading Treatment or Punishment, adopted in New York on December 10, 1984; any other international legal obligations; and the Constitution, laws, regulations, and immigration and visa policies of Sierra Leone. Consistent with this intention, the Government of Sierra Leone assures the Government of the United States of America that it would treat any ECOWAS citizens transferred from the United States to Sierra Leone in a manner that is in accordance with its international legal obligations and that the ECOWAS citizens removed to Sierra Leone would not be subjected to persecution on account of race, religion, nationality, membership in a particular social group, or political opinion, or torture in Sierra Leone or in any country to which the Government of Sierra Leone may further transfer them.

The Government of Sierra Leone may decide, at any time, that it is no longer willing to consider accepting the transfer from the United States to Sierra Leone of ECOWAS citizens present in the United States and in such case expects to communicate that decision in writing to the Government of the United States of America.

The Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International Cooperation of the Republic of Sierra Leone avails itself of this opportunity to renew to the Embassy of the United States of America in Freetown, Sierra Leone the assurances of its highest consideration.

FREETOWN, 20TH NOVEMBER 2025.

THE EMBASSY OF THE
UNITED STATES OF AMERICA
IN FREETOWN.



No. 014/POL/26

The Embassy of the United States of America presents its compliments to the Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International Cooperation of the Republic of Sierra Leone and has the honor to confirm receipt of the Note Verbale 15277/10/Vol. 79 received from the ministry on January 21, 2026.

The Embassy of the United States of America confirms the understanding reflected in the above referenced Note Verbale. The Embassy of the United States of America further informs the Government of the Republic of Sierra Leone that it does not intend to propose for transfer any individuals with violent criminal backgrounds, to the extent known to the Government of the United States of America.

The Embassy of the United States of America takes this opportunity to renew to the Government of Sierra Leone the assurances of its highest consideration.

Embassy of the United States of America
Freetown, January 26, 2026.

